

Daily Need to Know

Thursday, 24 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
<i>US cash equities & volatility — settled 16:00 ET Wed 23 Sep = 04:00 GMT+8, 2h 02m old at capture</i>			
S&P 500	7,706.03	▼ 58.61 -0.75%	Opened on its high (7,761.94) and closed at 17% of the day's range. Inside Hedgeye's 7536–7795 band at 65.6% ; 1.42% below the 52-week high. Still +0.7% on the week (AP).
Nasdaq Composite	26,936.04	▼ 308.24 -1.13%	One session after a record close, gave back 308 points; closed at 18% of range. 1.29% below the 52-week high set Tuesday.
Dow Jones Industrial	51,511.59	▼ 352.10 -0.68%	Closed at 9% of a 369-point range — on the low. Second straight session of distribution; 5.9% below the 52-week high.
Russell 2000	2,838.66	▼ 51.26 -1.77%	Closed on the low — 0.6% of range — and 7.3 points below the floor of Hedgeye's 2846–2916 bearish band. Worst of the five. 7.5% below its 52-week high.
Philadelphia SOX	12,534.28	▼ 155.54 -1.23%	Fell 2.5% intraday and recovered to mid-range (56%). Memory split: MU -2.22%, SNDK -3.73%, but WDC +1.96% and AMAT +0.41%.
VIX	15.17	▲ 0.95 +6.68%	Back above Tuesday's broken floor; closed at 79% of range. 35.9% of the new 13.75–17.70 band. The bigger move was in bonds: MOVE +21.5% to 95.45 .
<i>US index futures — Wednesday settles; the feed had not rolled at 06:01 or 06:06 GMT+8 (Globex reopened 06:00)</i>			
ES (E-mini S&P)	7,772.50	▼ 59.25 -0.76%	Settle, not a live print — byte-identical across two pulls five minutes apart. Basis to cash +66.5pts (+0.86%) , consistent with a genuine settle. Volume 93% of 10-day average.
NQ (E-mini Nasdaq-100)	30,764.75	▼ 263.75 -0.85%	Printed a 52-week high of 31,094.75 in the overnight session before the cash open, then gave it all back. Matches Newsquawk's NDX -0.85%.
YM (E-mini Dow)	51,873	▼ 406 -0.78%	Basis +361pts (+0.70%). Closed at 6% of range.
RTY (E-mini Russell)	2,860.20	▼ 53.90 -1.85%	Closed at 2.5% of range; basis +21.5 (+0.76%). Volume 81% of average — this was not a volume capitulation.
<i>US Treasury yields — cash series, New York close</i>			
US 10-year	5.110%	▲ 15.5bp	Highest since 2007 ; high 5.135% is the 52-week high. 2bp above the ceiling of Hedgeye's 4.89–5.09 band, published the same morning.
US 30-year	5.397%	▲ 10.2bp	Lagged the belly by 7bp. 10s30s compressed to 28.7bp from 34.0bp.
US 5-year	4.997%	▲ 17.0bp	The day's biggest mover. First 5% print since 2007 after a \$70bn auction tailed 3.1bp — per Newsquawk, the second-largest tail on record.
US 2-year	4.897%	▲ 15.0bp	High 4.945% = 52-week high. 10s2s 21.3bp (from 20.8bp); 5s2s 10.0bp. The "Fed front-runner" Hedgeye flagged broke out.
US 13-week bill	4.136%	▲ 3.1bp	Closed on its high, which is also the 52-week high. 10s3m +97.4bp.
<i>Energy — front-month futures, Wednesday settles</i>			
WTI (CL, Nov)	\$92.16	▲ 1.64 +1.81%	Settle confirmed at 92.16 (+1.64) by Newsquawk. Snapped a five-day losing streak (CNBC). 21.6% of a widened 87.51–109.07 band.
Brent (BZ1!, Nov)	\$103.08	▲ 3.83 +3.86%	This is the expiring November contract. The benchmark December (Z6) settled 98.12 (+2.71) — a \$4.96 backwardation between the two.
Natural gas	\$3.023	▲ 0.058 +1.96%	Hedgeye upgraded the TREND signal bearish → bullish and raised the band to 2.80–3.09. Now 76.9% of it. Volume only 62% of average.
RBOB gasoline	\$3.3404	▲ 0.1183 +3.67%	Closed at 90% of range. EIA gasoline stocks -1.686m bbl vs +0.1m expected . Diesel ban headline (below) hit distillates, not gasoline.
<i>Metals — SPOT, the series Hedgeye names; session rolled 18:00 ET, so the change column is ~2 minutes old</i>			
Gold spot	\$4,289.60	◆ new session	Wednesday's real move: -1.39% against yesterday's 09:10 capture of 4,350.15; COMEX GC settled -1.33% to 4,318.40. 30.3% of the 4249–4383 band. Dollar and yields both up — the Quad 2 combination Hedgeye calls negative for gold.

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
Silver spot	\$64.42	◆ new session	-3.8% against yesterday's capture of 66.95; SI futures -2.35%, SLV -4.23%. Back inside the bearish 62–67 band at 48.4% after closing above Tuesday's ceiling.
Copper spot	\$6.6750	◆ new session	-1.35% against yesterday's capture of 6.7662; HG futures -1.21% to 6.7535. Band unchanged at 6.35–6.80 bullish; now 72.2%.
<i>FX & crypto — live; majors rolled 17:00 ET, so their change column covers ~61 minutes</i>			
DXY	101.114	▲ 0.573 +0.57%	Still carries Wednesday's full session. High 101.23 = year-to-date high (Newsquawk: 101.231). 90.7% of Hedgeye's 99.79–101.25 bullish band — 14 cents from the ceiling.
USD/JPY	158.303	◆ new session	+0.73 yen (+0.46%) since yesterday's 09:10 capture. Tokyo reopens today after a three-day holiday into a 5.11% US 10-year.
USD/KRW	1,364.87	▲ 9.40 +0.69%	Won -0.69% on the day. Korea is shut Thursday to Saturday for Chuseok — no onshore market to reprice this.
Bitcoin	\$84,399.89	▼ 1,776.15 -2.06%	The only genuinely 24-hour row. Traded 87,266 (matching Monday's high) then sold to 83,523. 33.1% below the 52-week high of 126,230. Ether -2.73% to 2,678.

▲ up ▼ down ◆ unchanged or not meaningful. Cash equity and VIX rows are settled closes from Wednesday 23 September. Every other row was captured in a 2.2-second window at 06:01:36–06:01:38 GMT+8 and re-pulled at 06:06:00. Futures, Treasury, DX, KRW and all ETF rows were identical across both pulls, so they are Wednesday settles; spot metals, FX majors and crypto moved, so they are live. Reconciliation: all four headline indices match the AP closing wire to the cent, WTI matches the Newsquawk settle exactly, and the 2-, 5-, 10- and 30-year yields match Newsquawk to within 0.2bp. Yahoo Finance returned nothing — see section 18.

TL;DR — A five-year-high flash PMI (composite 58.4, manufacturing 57.0 vs 53.6 expected) with **input costs rising at the fastest rate in four years**, a Fed governor saying "**further rate hikes are likely needed**", and a \$70bn five-year auction that **tailed 3.1bp** pushed the 10-year to **5.11%, its highest since 2007**. The 5-year crossed 5% for the first time since 2007. Bond volatility (MOVE) jumped 21.5%. Equities fell in a way the headline S&P -0.75% understates: the **Russell closed on its low and through Hedgeye's floor**, high yield (HYG), investment grade (LQD), long Treasuries (TLT) and utilities (XLU) all printed **52-week lows**, and energy was the only sector up. Hedgeye's thesis for the regime — dollar up, rates up, curve flat — played out on the day it was published. Today: **Tokyo reopens after three days shut, Korea closes for three**, and Trump hosts Xi at the White House.

2 The big picture — what it means

- The bond market, not the stock market, made the news.** A 15.5bp move in the 10-year, 17bp in the 5-year and 15bp in the 2-year, on a day with no CPI, no payrolls and no Fed decision, is a repricing of the path, not of a data point. The trigger was a flash PMI that beat on every line; the amplifier was supply. The 5-year auction's 3.1bp tail says the marginal buyer wanted a materially higher yield to take \$70bn of paper — and did not get enough of it.
- The PMI's inflation detail matters more than its growth headline.** S&P Global said input costs rose at the steepest rate in four years, driven by fuel and transport, and that growing backlogs signal firms "developing more pricing power". Employment grew at the fastest pace since June 2022. That is a growth-plus-inflation print — exactly Hedgeye's Quad 2 — landing one week after the Fed's first hike since 2023.
- The Fed is not signalling that one hike was enough.** Governor Michael Barr said further increases are "likely needed" and that inflation is not clearly trending to 2%. With the 2-year at **4.897%** and the 13-week bill at a 52-week high, the front end is pricing more. The curve kept flattening at the long end: 10s30s is down to **28.7bp**.
- The equity damage was concentrated where rates bite.** Russell -1.77% and closed on the low; utilities -1.92% to within 4 cents of a 52-week low; real estate -1.55%; discretionary -1.50%. Equal-weight RSP (-0.70%) roughly matched the cap-weighted SPY (-0.72%), so this was broad, not a mega-cap unwind. Newsquawk counted over 72% of US issues lower.
- Credit cracked quietly.** HYG closed at **78.10, three cents off its 52-week low** of 78.07 and 20 cents below Hedgeye's bearish floor, on volume 53% above its 10-day average. LQD and TLT both printed 52-week lows. A week ago the same three ETFs made 52-week lows and closed flat on a bid; this time the bid did not show up.
- Oil rose against the diplomacy.** Three hours of US–Iran talks at the UN and a White House denial of a diesel export ban should have been bearish. Instead WTI snapped a five-day losing streak and December Brent rose 2.8% on a Libyan field blockade and Iran's refusal to drop its Hormuz preconditions. Energy (XLE +0.96%) was the only positive sector — the level Hedgeye started buying on Tuesday.
- The Asian handover is lopsided.** Tokyo has been shut since Friday, when the Nikkei closed at 65,018.95 after the Bank of Japan decision; it reopens this morning into three US sessions of news and a 5.11% US 10-year. Korea, the market most exposed to Wednesday's memory-chip selling, closes today for three days. Whatever Seoul would have repriced, Tokyo and Taipei absorb instead.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **Curve:** belly-led bear move. 2y +15.0bp, 5y +17.0bp, 10y +15.5bp, 30y +10.2bp (capture; Newsquawk agrees to 0.2bp). 10s2s steepened slightly to 21.3bp because the 10-year beat the 2-year by half a basis point — the flattening Hedgeye flagged was in 10s30s, not 10s2s.
- **Bond volatility:** MOVE +21.5% to **95.45**, opening on its low and closing on its high. Hedgeye is long PFIX for exactly this; the call worked the day after it was restated.
- **Dollar:** DXY **101.114 (+0.57%)**, year-to-date high 101.23. Energy-importing currencies (AUD, NZD, GBP, JPY) underperformed on the diesel-ban headline, per Newsquawk. USD/KRW 1,364.87 (+0.69%), USD/TWD 31.852 (+0.63%), USD/CNH 6.711 — the yuan barely moved ahead of Xi's visit.
- **Crude:** WTI Nov settled **92.16 (+1.64)**, Brent Dec **98.12 (+2.71)**. EIA: crude stocks +2.97m bbl vs a 0.6m draw expected, gasoline -1.69m vs +0.1m, distillates -0.43m vs -0.6m, SPR -0.41m, production flat at 13.94m b/d. A crude build and a rally in the same session means the barrel is trading geopolitics, not inventory.
- **Diesel:** Politico reported a 90-day diesel export ban; a White House official denied it to Reuters and Energy Secretary Chris Wright said "nobody is considering a flat ban". Reuters put retail diesel above **\$6.50 a gallon**, a record. US diesel futures fell on the report.
- **Precious metals:** gold -1.33% and silver -2.35% on futures settle; SLV -4.23% was the worst of the metal ETFs. Rising real yields and a rising dollar together — the Macro Show deck says gold and silver are "confirming bearish trade signals".
- **Grains:** wheat -1.22% to 708.50. Hedgeye cut its CORN long to minimum size on Wednesday's Macro Show.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

SIGNAL	READING	HEDGEYE'S READ
Quad path	NOT PRINTED	The Early Look's title is "#Quad2 = Dollar Up, Rates Up" and Hedgeye published a note titled "U.S. PMI Weapons-Grade QUAD2" at 14:42 ET (outside this subscription). No explicit forward path was seen. Absence of a printed path is not evidence it is unchanged.
Regime logic	#Quad2	Growth and inflation surprising up → yields and dollar break out → Fed hawkish on a lag → 2-year leads, curve flattens, financials suffer.
Short-dated vol	~20 → 9	Calendar vol collapsed in a week as hedges were unwound after the Fed hike. Hedgeye treats that complacency as the chance to rebuild protection.
Real-Time Alerts	7 shorts / 2 longs	Both longs are energy. Short book named on air: IWM (puts added), XLU, XLI, AMZN, JPM, Germany (EWG), Switzerland, consumer, airlines.
Longs named	Inflation / rates	Brent (BNO; Alpha Code ~97/90, neither broken), PFIX, BTC, ETH, MSOS, XLE, PBR, GSL, BWET, IGV. CORN cut to minimum.
Signal Strength	49 stocks	23 Sep 11:58 ET: added ACHC, PI, SHOP, CVI; removed CZR, LFST, LH, SJM.
KOSPI	No position	Back to bullish TRADE and "barely" bullish TREND per the Macro Show; Hedgeye has no position.

Risk Range™ Signals — Early Look, 23 September 07:25 ET (19:25 GMT+8), Keith McCullough

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	PRIOR (22 SEP)	Δ FLOOR / CEILING	WIDTH	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
UST 10-year yield	4.89–5.09	bullish	4.85–5.10	+0.04 / -0.01	0.25 → 0.20	5.110 — ABOVE the ceiling by 0.02. The band was narrowed the same morning and broken the same afternoon.
High Yield (HYG)	78.30–79.00	bearish	78.28–78.98	+0.02 / +0.02	unchanged 0.70	78.10 — BELOW the floor by 0.20 , three cents off the 52-week low. Bearish signal confirmed.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	103.8–105.6	bearish	103.6–105.6	+0.2 / 0	2.0 → 1.8	103.89 — 5.0%, on the floor. 52-week low 103.68 printed intraday.
S&P 500 (SPX)	7536–7795	bullish	7532–7797	+4 / -2	265 → 259	7,706.03 — 65.6%. Fell from 87.8% on Tuesday; 170 points above the floor.
NASDAQ Comp. (COMPQ)	26359–27351	bullish	25901–27305	+458 / +46	1,404 → 992	26,936.04 — 58.2%. The biggest band move in the table: floor lifted 458 points and width cut 29%.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2846–2916	bearish	2834–2825 (printed inverted)	n/m	n/m	2,838.66 — BELOW the floor by 7.34. Tuesday's band was printed with floor above ceiling, so no clean diff exists.
Health Care (XLV)	165–172	bullish	164–171	+1 / +1	unchanged 7	168.80 — 54.3%. Hedgeye's long fell 0.64%; FXH -1.07%.
Software (IGV)	101–110	bullish	102–110	-1 / 0	8 → 9	Not in the capture universe. Position unknown.
Energy (XLE)	61.17–66.00	bullish	61.57–65.98	-0.40 / +0.02	4.41 → 4.83	62.37 — 24.8%. Floor lowered to give the new long room; price rose 0.96%.
Volatility (VIX)	13.75–17.70	bearish	14.24–17.85	-0.49 / -0.15	3.61 → 3.95	15.17 — 35.9%. Back inside after Tuesday's close below the floor.
US Dollar (USD)	99.79–101.25	bullish	99.68–100.99	+0.11 / +0.26	1.31 → 1.46	101.114 — 90.7%. Ceiling raised 26 cents and price almost caught it.

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	PRIOR (22 SEP)	Δ FLOOR / CEILING	WIDTH	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
Crude, WTIC continuous	87.51–109.07	bullish	90.17–108.16	–2.66 / +0.91	17.99 → 21.56	92.16 — 21.6%. Floor cut to fit Tuesday's break below it: the band moved to the price, not the reverse.
Nat gas continuous	2.80–3.09	bullish ▲	2.74–2.96 (bearish)	+0.06 / +0.13	0.22 → 0.29	3.023 — 76.9%. SIGNAL UPGRADED bearish → bullish , after price closed above the old ceiling.
Gold spot	4249–4383	neutral	4244–4399	+5 / –16	155 → 134	4,289.60 — 30.3% on TVC:GOLD. On COMEX futures (4,318.40) it would misread 51.8%.
Copper spot	6.35–6.80	bullish	6.35–6.80	0 / 0	unchanged	6.675 — 72.2% on OANDA spot. HG futures at 6.7535 would misread 89.7%.
Silver spot	62–67	bearish	62–66	0 / +1	4 → 5	64.42 — 48.4%. Ceiling raised to accommodate Tuesday's break; Wednesday's fall then brought price back to mid-band.

Prior bands are taken from the 22 September Early Look as reproduced in yesterday's edition in the archive, not from Hedgeye's feed, which does not paginate. Positions are measured on the series Hedgeye names: spot for gold, silver and copper; the continuous contract for crude and natural gas. These bands were published **before** Wednesday's session: three of sixteen (10-year, HYG, RUT) were broken by the close, all in the direction of Hedgeye's signal.

Band moves in one line: one signal changed — **natural gas upgraded to bullish**. The Nasdaq floor rose 458 points while the S&P band barely moved, so Hedgeye tightened risk on the index that had just made a record. Crude's floor was cut \$2.66 and XLE's 40 cents — both loosened to hold longs that had broken or nearly broken. The dollar ceiling rose. Nothing on the bearish side (HYG, LQD, RUT, VIX, silver) was relaxed.

What Keith actually said

From the Early Look, "#Quad2 = Dollar Up, Rates Up", 23 September 07:25 ET / 19:25 GMT+8:

- On the mechanism: "Our Fed Front-Runner (UST 2yr Yield) breaks out faster than the Long-end of the Yield Curve can keep up".
- On the squeeze: "#Quad2 is where you get plenty of Short Squeezes in High Beta Factor Exposures" — citing Goldman's most-short basket +2.3% Monday and +1.6% Tuesday.
- On volatility: short-dated calendar vol went to 20 before the Fed and was "smoked down to 9!" by Tuesday's close.
- On pair trades: long MU versus short JPM, noting MU's +6% SPY impact against JPM's –4%; XLF –2.0% against the XLV long +0.5%. Cannabis (MSOS) +7.9%.

The Macro Show material above comes from Hedgeye's Summary Notes for Wednesday 23 September, 10:36 ET / 22:36 GMT+8. Those notes carry the publisher's own warning — "SUMMARY HAS BEEN ENHANCED BY AI AND MAY CONTAIN ERRORS" — so they are reported as attributed summary and kept outside quotation marks. Only the Early Look is quoted verbatim.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
NVIDIA	225.51	–1.47%	\$5.43T	Down with the complex, not leading it. 4.7% below its 52-week high; volume 82% of average — no rush for the exit.
Apple	337.02	–0.80%	\$4.92T	Gave back the Tuesday 52-week high; closed 2.4% under it on volume 69% of average.
Alphabet	337.83	–3.80%	\$4.11T	Worst of the seven , closed on the low (3% of range) on volume 123% of average. No single catalyst found — see §18. 17.3% below its 52-week high.
Microsoft	500.59	+0.52%	\$3.72T	Reclaimed the 500 handle — one of only two up on the day — after trading 509.44 intraday.
Amazon	249.27	–2.24%	\$2.69T	–2.24% on volume 120% of average. Named as a Hedgeye short on Wednesday's Macro Show.
Meta Platforms	744.10	+1.02%	\$1.90T	New 52-week high of 763.90 on Connect day one, then faded to close at 19% of range. +0.42% after hours.
Tesla	380.12	+0.32%	\$1.50T	Flat-to-up and still 23.8% below its 52-week high — deepest drawdown in the group.

Combined capitalisation \$24.27 trillion, down from \$24.57 trillion yesterday. Five of seven fell. Capitalisations are TradingView's market_cap_basic at capture.

6 Positioning & options

- **Credit volume was the tell.** HYG traded 68.9m shares against a 45.2m average (+53%); TLT 53.4m vs 40.4m (+32%); LQD +15%. SPY ran 111% of average and QQQ 91%. The heaviest relative volume was in bonds, not stocks.
- **Hedges were light going in.** Hedgeye's short-dated calendar vol of 9 at Tuesday's close and the VIX below its floor meant the market entered Wednesday under-hedged. VIX rose 6.7%; the MOVE rose three times as much.
- **Utilities were sold on volume.** XLU traded 27.9m vs 21.8m average (+28%) and closed four cents above its 52-week low of 39.71. Hedgeye's #1 sector-style short is now –1.92% in a day on top of –10.3% for the quarter through Monday.

- **Small-cap futures did not capitulate.** RTY volume was 81% of its 10-day average on a -1.85% day; ES 93%. A close on the low without volume is a trend, not a flush.
- **Crypto rotated rather than de-risked.** Bitcoin fell ~2% while Bitcoin Cash rose 28% after CME said it would list BCH and Uniswap futures from 19 October (CoinDesk). Hedgeye remains long BTC and ETH, and notes Bitcoin is currently positively correlated with the dollar.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR (SPDR)	LAST	DAY	VOL VS AVG	NOTE
Energy (XLE)	62.37	+0.96%	97%	The only sector up. Hedgeye bought it on Tuesday; 24.8% of its band.
Industrials (XLI)	170.10	-0.10%	104%	Flat; one of Hedgeye's named shorts, held up best of the rest.
Staples (XLP)	82.43	-0.36%	104%	Defensive, but not a hiding place at a 5.1% 10-year.
Technology (XLK)	195.34	-0.47%	80%	Closed mid-range; 1.7% below its 52-week high.
Financials (XLF)	54.54	-0.47%	109%	Bounced intraday to 55.08 and faded. 42.7m shares, 109% of average.
Materials (XLB)	50.28	-0.49%	104%	Tuesday's leader; gave back a third of its gain as copper fell.
Health Care (XLV)	168.80	-0.64%	95%	Hedgeye long; high 171.02 not held.
Communication (XLC)	112.56	-0.85%	100%	Alphabet -3.80% did the damage.
Cons. Discretionary (XLY)	110.65	-1.50%	104%	Amazon -2.24%; McDonald's at a four-year low (Newsquawk). 11.5% below its 52-week high.
Real Estate (XLRE)	41.84	-1.55%	129%	Closed at 5% of range. The direct casualty of a 5.4% 30-year.
Utilities (XLU)	39.75	-1.92%	128%	Worst sector, closed at 6% of range, 4 cents above the 52-week low.

- **Leaders:** energy, and nothing else. The next four "best" sectors all fell.
- **Laggards:** utilities, real estate, discretionary, communication — the four most sensitive to the discount rate or the consumer.
- **Rotation:** this was the rate-sensitive book being sold, not a rotation into anything. Hedgeye's short list (XLU, IWM, consumer) was the losing side; its long list (XLE, BNO, PFI) the winning side, with the exception of XLV.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

There is no overnight tape to read yet. At 06:01 and again at 06:06 GMT+8 every futures contract returned Wednesday's settle to the cent: Globex reopened at 06:00 GMT+8 and the ~10-minute-delayed feed had not rolled. FX majors have ~61 minutes of session and spot metals ~6 minutes — EUR/USD has covered 11 pips, USD/JPY 16 sen. None of it is information. Crypto is the one live market: Bitcoin -2.1% on 24 hours. The NQ overnight high of 31,094.75 printed before Wednesday's cash open is the last genuinely informative futures level.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Thu 24 Sep today	Tokyo reopens after Silver Week (shut 21–23 Sep); Japan flash PMIs. Korea closed 24–26 Sep for Chuseok. 09:30 Australian labour force, August. Policy decisions from the SNB, Norges Bank and Riksbank (European afternoon) and Banxico; German Ifo. 20:30 US initial jobless claims. 22:00 new home sales, August. Fed: Williams, Barkin, Hammack, Paulson. Trump–Xi at the White House and state dinner — trade, Taiwan, AI, Iran, rare earths, fentanyl; Huang, Altman, Cook, Pichai, Musk, Bezos and Dell reported attending. Meta Connect day two. Costco reports after the US close (Fri morning GMT+8); Darden pre-open.
Fri 25 Sep	20:30 durable goods orders, August. 22:00 University of Michigan sentiment, September final (preliminary 47.8, year-ahead inflation expectations 4.6%). Hammack again.
Mon 28 – Wed 30 Sep	29 Sep: Conference Board confidence; RBA decision. 30 Sep: Micron FQ4 results — the print for memory, after MU -2.22% and SNDK -3.73% on Wednesday. November Brent expires.
Ahead	27–28 October FOMC (non-SEP). 10 November: US tariff exclusions and China's rare-earth export-control suspension expire — the leverage behind this week's summit.

US times converted at +12h (US daylight time). Thursday's release list is from Newsquawk's daily calendar, which gave no consensus figures; consensus for claims, new home sales and durables was not found and is left blank rather than guessed. Central bank decision times are standard-schedule and unconfirmed. Earnings dates are from secondary calendars and unconfirmed, except Micron (30 Sep) and the FOMC (27–28 Oct), carried from yesterday's verified edition.

9 Corporate news

- **McDonald's** fell to a four-year low (Newsquawk) at its investor day after guiding Q3 US business slightly negative and unveiling a plan reported at \$8.5bn to support franchisees and remodel restaurants. Not in the capture universe; level unverified.
- **Cracker Barrel** rose 7.88% on a fiscal Q4 beat (TheStreet). **Cintas, General Mills and Paychex** also reported pre-open; results not reviewed for this edition.

- **Viking Therapeutics** fell 8.19% after hours to \$38.24 on a proposed \$400m raise — \$200m of stock and \$200m of 2032 converts — against \$502m of cash at mid-year (Benzinga).
- **IonQ** rose 5.89% on a quantum error-correction result; **Securitize** +13.03%. **AppLovin** -3.79%, **WillScot** -3.98% (TheStreet).
- **Disney** raised Disney+ to \$21.49 a month (+13%); **GE HealthCare** raised its dividend 14% (Newsquawk).
- **Palantir** +3.68% to 191.79, closing at 82% of range on volume 135% of average — the strongest large-cap tech name on a down day. **Workday** +2.20%. **Oracle** -3.11% to 144.56, 55.2% below its 52-week high.

10 Macro data

- **S&P Global flash US PMI, September:** manufacturing **57.0 vs 53.6 consensus** (prior 53.9) — a 3.4-point beat; services **58.7 vs 56.0** (prior 56.5); composite **58.4** (prior 56.0), strongest since July 2021, fourth straight acceleration. Input costs at the steepest rate since October 2022; employment growth fastest since June 2022; backlogs fastest since May 2022. Consensus from Newsquawk; FXStreet had 53.5 and 56.0.
- **EIA weekly petroleum:** crude +2.969m bbl vs -0.6m expected; gasoline -1.686m vs +0.1m; distillate -0.428m vs -0.6m; SPR -0.405m.
- **5-year note auction:** \$70bn, tailed **3.1bp**; weak bid-to-cover and a sharp fall in indirect demand (Newsquawk).
- **Fed:** Governor Barr — further hikes "likely needed"; inflation not clearly heading to 2%. The Fed raised rates on 16 September, its first increase since 2023.
- **Carried context:** Hedgeye's September CPI nowcast stood at 3.67% y/y vs the 3.40% August print (yesterday's edition). August core CPI was +0.3% m/m vs +0.2% consensus.

11 Geopolitics

◆ **US–Iran:** President Trump described three hours of talks at the UN General Assembly as "very good" and "very productive" and said another meeting is planned. Iran denied it had dropped preconditions on the Strait of Hormuz and a senior official said "many differences remain". The Times of Israel, cited by Newsquawk, reported that the US dismissed an Iranian Hormuz offer on the grounds that Tehran does not control the strait — unconfirmed.

▲ **US–China:** Xi Jinping arrived at Joint Base Andrews for his first US state visit in 11 years. Reported deliverables: extension of tariff exclusions due to expire 10 November, aircraft and farm purchases, rare-earth licensing. No major breakthrough is expected, per Yahoo Finance.

▼ **Libya:** a new blockade hit El Sharara, the country's largest field at roughly a third of output (TheStreet).

◆ **Diesel:** the export-ban report and denial (section 3) matter politically: record pump prices into the midterms.

◆ **UK–US:** Chancellor Healey said he spoke with Treasury Secretary Bessent about stepping up pressure on Iran (Newsquawk).

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	STATUS
ES	7,772.50	-0.76%	Wed settle; volume 1,489,225
NQ	30,764.75	-0.85%	Wed settle; volume 526,332
YM	51,873	-0.78%	Wed settle; volume 73,819
RTY	2,860.20	-1.85%	Wed settle; volume 165,370
USD/JPY	158.303	-0.02%	live, 61-min session
USD/KRW	1,364.87	+0.69%	carries Wed session
USD/TWD	31.8521	+0.63%	carries Wed session
USD/CNH	6.7107	-0.01%	live
EUR/USD	1.1385	+0.01%	live
Gold spot	4,289.60	+0.07%	live, ~6-min session
Silver spot	64.419	-0.00%	live
Copper spot	6.6750	-0.09%	live
WTI	92.16	+1.81%	Wed settle
Brent (Nov)	103.08	+3.86%	Wed settle; Dec 98.12
Bitcoin	84,400	-2.06%	live, 24h

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	STATUS
Ether	2,678.02	-2.73%	live, 24h

- **Japan is the market with the most to reprice.** The Nikkei last traded on Friday 18 September, closing at 65,018.95 (+1.38%) after the BoJ. Since then: a US record on Tuesday, a 15bp rise in the US 10-year on Wednesday, USD/JPY up to 158.30, and SOX -1.23%. *Previous close, five days old.*
- **Korea hands over and walks away.** KOSPI closed Wednesday at 7,080.93 (+0.90%; Samsung +3.25%, SK Hynix +1.20%) and is shut until Monday 28 September. Wednesday's US memory selling (MU -2.22%, SNDK -3.73%) goes unpriced in Seoul for three sessions. *Previous close.*
- **Hong Kong and China** hand over from a weak session: HSI 24,834.13 (-1.01%), SSE 3,936.52 (-0.39%). The Xi visit is the live variable. *Previous closes.*
- **Taiwan** is the regional semiconductor proxy while Korea is closed; TWD fell 0.63% on Wednesday.
- **Australia** (ASX 8,765.30 previous close) gets its August jobs report at 09:30 with the RBA meeting on 29 September.
- **The single instrument most likely to move: USD/JPY.** A 158 handle, US yields at a 19-year high and Tokyo's first session in five days — the zone that triggered joint US–Japan intervention in late July.

13 AI watch

- **The state dinner is an AI summit in all but name.** Nvidia's Huang, OpenAI's Altman and Google's Pichai are reported to attend; chip export licences and AI governance are on the agenda.
- **The "pace the frontier" debate is still moving money.** NPR ran an analysis on Wednesday arguing an AI slowdown would entrench the largest labs. Anthropic's Dario Amodei's essay calling for slower frontier development has been in the tape since 14 September.
- **Memory split.** Newsquawk attributed Wednesday's chip weakness partly to fading enthusiasm after OpenAI's "Astra" model announcement; the chronology of that launch could not be verified this morning. WDC +1.96% and SNDK -3.73% on the same day is dispersion within storage, not a verdict on the theme.
- **Meta** made a 52-week high on Connect day one, then faded. Day two runs today.
- **Hedgeye's framing:** AI is "now the largest participant" in market flows, per the Early Look — a statement about market structure, not fundamentals.

14 Beyond the markets

- **The 5-year auction tail was the second-largest on record,** per Newsquawk. Supply, not just data, set the price of money on Wednesday — and there is more supply this week.
- **Diesel above \$6.50 a gallon** is a record. It feeds straight into the transport costs the PMI flagged, and into the political pressure behind the export-ban story.
- **A US crude build of 3m barrels coincided with a \$1.64 rally.** When inventory data stop mattering, geopolitics is doing the pricing.
- **A bitcoin wallet dormant for 14 years** holding 600 BTC (~\$52m) moved coins for the first time since July 2012; CoinDesk read it as a wallet migration, not a sale.
- **A year-to-date view from AP:** after Wednesday, the S&P is +12.6% for 2026, the Nasdaq +15.9%, the Russell +14.4% and the Dow +7.2%.

15 Appendix — stock cards

META · META PLATFORMS

744.10 +1.02%

Cap \$1.90T · 52w high 763.90 · next: Connect day two today

New 52-week high intraday, then closed at 19% of range. The market paid for the agent story and then declined to hold it overnight. +0.42% after hours.

GOOGL · ALPHABET

337.83 -3.80%

Cap \$4.11T · 52w high 408.61 · next: None confirmed

Closed on the low on 123% volume, the worst Mag7 day. No catalyst found; treat as rate-driven multiple compression until shown otherwise.

AMZN · AMAZON

249.27 -2.24%

Cap \$2.69T · 52w high 287.20 · next: None confirmed

Named Hedgeye short. -2.24% on 120% volume; 13.2% below its 52-week high.

MU · MICRON

1,071.88 -2.22%

Cap \$1.21T · 52w high 1,255.00 · next: FQ4 results 30 Sep

Hedgeye's long leg against JPM. -2.22%, closed at 18% of range. Six sessions to the print that decides the memory trade.

SNDK · SANDISK**1,816.57** -3.73%

Cap \$0.27T · 52w high 2,354.39 · next: None confirmed

Gave back 3.73% of Tuesday's 6.82% Rosenblatt-initiation rally. Still 22.8% below its 52-week high.

PLTR · PALANTIR**191.79** +3.68%

Cap \$0.46T · 52w high 207.52 · next: None confirmed

+3.68% on 135% volume on a down day; closed at 82% of range. 7.6% below its 52-week high.

ORCL · ORACLE**144.56** -3.11%

Cap \$0.44T · 52w high 322.54 · next: None confirmed

-3.11%, closed at 7% of range. 55.2% below its 52-week high — the deepest drawdown among the large AI-capex names.

XLU · UTILITIES SPDR**39.75** -1.92%

Cap ETF · 52w high 47.80 · next: n/a

Hedgeye's #1 sector-style short. Closed 4 cents above a 52-week low on 128% volume. Nothing about a 5.4% long bond helps it.

16 About this edition

- **Covers:** the US cash session of Wednesday 23 September as settled (04:00 GMT+8), the after-hours tape, Hedgeye's full Wednesday publication set, and overnight FX, metals and crypto to the moment of capture.
- **Captured:** 06:01:36–06:01:38 GMT+8 (2.2s), TradingView 96/96; re-pulled 06:06:00 to classify live vs settled rows. Yahoo returned nothing. Divergences are reconciled in section 18.
- **Timing:** the run fired at 06:01 GMT+8, one minute after Globex reopened. Futures therefore carry Wednesday settles, not overnight prints; FX majors contain ~61–66 minutes of session and spot metals ~2–6 minutes.
- **Settled vs live:** cash equities, VIX, futures, Treasuries, DXY, KRW, TWD and all ETFs are settled; spot metals, FX majors and crypto are live.
- **Hedgeye edition:** full subscriber access. The live risk-range set is the Early Look of 23 September 07:25 ET (19:25 GMT+8) by Keith McCullough; Thursday's Early Look (~19:25 GMT+8 today) supersedes it. Also read: Macro Show Summary Notes (23 Sep), Signal Strength Stocks (23 Sep). The PMI note was outside the subscription.
- **Quad path:** not printed; regime described throughout as #Quad2. No change can be asserted.
- **Not available:** "U.S. PMI | Weapons-Grade QUAD2" (access denied); MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, KM's Top 3 and Chart of the Day did not appear in the feed.

17 Sources

Prices: TradingView scanner (bulk capture 06:01:36 and 06:06:00 GMT+8). Yahoo Finance attempted, returned nothing. Cross-checks: AP "How major US stock indexes fared Wednesday 9/23/2026"; Newsquawk US Market Wrap and Crude Wrap (23 Sep); TradingKey (KOSPI close); BBN Times and IBTimes (Nikkei last close).

Hedgeye: Early Look "#Quad2 = Dollar Up, Rates Up" (23 Sep 07:25 ET); The Macro Show Summary Notes (23 Sep 10:36 ET); Signal Strength Stocks (23 Sep 11:58 ET); prior bands from the 22 Sep Early Look via yesterday's archived edition.

Macro: S&P Global flash US PMI press release (September); Trading Economics; FXStreet and Newsquawk for consensus; EIA figures via Newsquawk; Fed Governor Barr via Newsquawk.

Narrative and single stocks: TheStreet, Yahoo Finance live blog, Charles Schwab, Benzinga, CoinDesk, NPR.

Commodities, geopolitics, AI: Newsquawk, Reuters via GV Wire, CNBC headline, FinanceFeeds (Xi visit agenda), Newsquawk daily calendar (24 Sep).

18 Data-confidence**CROSS-CHECKS PASSED**

- **Machine reconciliation: 0 match · 0 minor · 0 divergent · 57 single-sourced.** Yahoo circuit-broke on five consecutive HTTP 429s in 2.2 seconds, as it has on every recent run. There are no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran — this is not a clean reconciliation, and the checks below are what replace it.
- **AP closing wire, four indices, exact to the cent:** SPX 7,706.03 (–58.61), Dow 51,511.59 (–352.10), Nasdaq 26,936.04 (–308.24), Russell 2,838.66 (–51.26). Capture: 7,706.03 / –58.61; 51,511.59 / –352.10; 26,936.0365 / –308.2412; 2,838.6604 / –51.2585.
- **Prior-close arithmetic ties to yesterday's archived edition:** 7,706.03 + 58.61 = 7,764.64; 26,936.04 + 308.24 = 27,244.28; 51,511.59 + 352.10 = 51,863.69; 2,838.66 + 51.26 = 2,889.92; VIX 15.17 – 0.95 = 14.22. All five match the settles printed on 23 September.
- **Newsquawk wraps:** WTI Nov settle 92.16 (+1.64) matches CL1! exactly. Yields: 2y 4.897 (+15.0bp) exact; 5y 4.997 (+17.0bp) exact; 10y 5.108 (+15.3bp) vs capture 5.110 (+15.5bp), 0.2bp; 30y 5.398 (+10.3bp) vs 5.397 (+10.2bp), 0.1bp. DXY year-to-date high 101.231 vs captured session high 101.23. SPX –0.75%, NDX –0.85% (NQ1! –0.85%), RUT –1.77% all match.

- **Asia:** KOSPI 7,080.92 (TradingKey) vs 7,080.93 captured; Nikkei 65,018.95 (BBN Times) vs 65,018.73 captured — a 0.22-point difference in a stale Friday close, immaterial.
- **Futures-versus-cash basis confirms the settles:** ES +66.5pts (+0.86%), YM +361 (+0.70%), RTY +21.5 (+0.76%), NQ vs Newsquawk's NDX 30,470 +295 (+0.97%). A 27bp cluster with the Nasdaq contract widest is normal for December contracts at 5% funding. ES -0.76% vs SPX -0.75% on the day.
- **Live-versus-settled test:** two pulls at 06:01:36 and 06:06:00. Every futures, Treasury, DXY, KRW, TWD and equity/ETF price was identical; spot gold (+3.81), silver, copper, EUR/USD, USD/JPY, USD/CNH, GBP, AUD, BTC and ETH moved. That is the classification used throughout.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **Manufacturing PMI 57.0 vs 56.7.** Trading Economics printed 56.7 as "Manufacturing PMI"; S&P Global's own release gives the headline PMI as 57.0 and the manufacturing *output* index as 56.7. The brief uses 57.0. Consensus differs by source: 53.6 (Newsquawk) vs 53.5 (FXStreet); the beat is 3.4–3.5 points either way.
- **Brent — two contracts.** TradingView's BZ1! is the expiring November contract at 103.08 (+3.83); the benchmark December (Z6) settled 98.12 (+2.71) per Newsquawk. The \$4.96 gap is front-end backwardation, not an error. Any "Brent" level quoted elsewhere this morning may be either.
- **Intraday commodity marks in press copy are stale.** TheStreet's snapshot had WTI -0.97% at 89.64, gold 4,351.70 and silver 65.71 — mid-session prints before the rally and the metals slide. Settles used instead.
- **Spot-metal and FX-major change columns are noise.** Gold's +0.07% and USD/JPY's -0.02% cover minutes. Wednesday's real moves are stated against yesterday's 09:10 GMT+8 capture (gold -1.39%, silver -3.8%, copper -1.35%, USD/JPY +0.46%) — that interval is ~21 hours and includes Tuesday's overnight session, so it is an approximation of the Wednesday move, robust in direction and roughly right in size. Futures settle changes (GC -1.33%, SI -2.35%, HG -1.21%) are the cleaner single-session figures.
- **Gold basis:** COMEX GC 4,318.40 vs spot 4,289.60 = 0.67%. Measured on futures, gold would read 51.8% of its band instead of 30.3%; copper 89.7% instead of 72.2%.
- **Hedgeye prior bands come from our own archive,** not from Hedgeye directly: the 22 September values are as reproduced in yesterday's edition. The Russell row was printed inverted (2834–2825) and is not diffed.
- **McDonald's** four-year low and the \$8.5bn plan are single-sourced to Newsquawk and an FX Leaders headline; MCD is outside the capture and no price is printed.
- **OpenAI "Astra":** Newsquawk linked Wednesday's chip weakness to it, but other coverage dates GPT-6 Astra to early September. Reported as attribution only.

KNOWN GAPS

- **No machine second source.** Yahoo 0/62. Every price is TradingView; the wire checks above cover 15 rows directly.
- **Alphabet -3.80%** on 123% volume: no specific catalyst found. The widely indexed "\$205bn capex" story is from 23 July and was rejected as a false match.
- **Hedgeye coverage:** "U.S. PMI | Weapons-Grade QUAD2" returned ACCESS DENIED (subscription boundary). MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, KM's Top 3 / From The Desk and Chart of the Day did not appear in the feed; those are the publications through which a position change would be disclosed. **Absence of a Hedgeye position change in this brief is NOT evidence there was none.**
- **Quad path:** no explicit forward path notation was seen; the US Monthly Quad Forecast sits in a PDF behind a secondary link that was not read this run.
- **IGV** (Hedgeye band 101–110) is still outside the capture universe; position unknown. OIH is no longer in the published set.
- **After-hours:** H.B. Fuller and Stitch Fix results were not reviewed; Cintas, General Mills and Paychex pre-market results not reviewed.
- **Consensus** for Thursday's jobless claims, new home sales and Friday's durables not found; left blank.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window 06:01:36–06:01:38 GMT+8** (2.2s), re-pull 06:06:00. Run started 06:01:27 GMT+8 = 18:01 ET Wednesday — on schedule, one minute after Globex reopened.
- **Row ages at capture:** cash equities, VIX and ETFs 2h 02m (settled 04:00 GMT+8); futures and Treasuries are Wednesday settles, roughly 1–4h old depending on the contract's settle time; FX majors ~61 minutes of new session; spot metals ~2 minutes (6 at re-pull); crypto live. **Stalest row: the Nikkei, last traded Friday 18 September, ~5.5 days (~132 hours) old.**
- **Superseded today:** Thursday's Early Look (~07:25 ET = 19:25 GMT+8) replaces every risk range in section 4. Tokyo's open at 08:00 GMT+8 replaces the stale Nikkei; the first genuinely informative futures prints arrive as the delayed feed rolls.
- **Verify live prices before acting.** Nothing in this brief is a recommendation.